

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Electricians' Workplace English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Electricians, electrical apprentices in supervised communication roles, electrical crew leads, and service coordinators.

Fictional occupational English practice, not electrical training or advice on design, testing, isolation, switching, energizing, repairs, or installation. All case facts, ratings, dimensions, schedules, and incidents are invented. Do not operate or investigate equipment to enact a scenario. Technical decisions and safety status belong to qualified personnel using applicable site arrangements; no universal code, permit, or licensing rules are asserted. Occupational sources inform context, not the invented technical cases.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Taking a precise electrical service request

Turn a broad complaint into an accurate service-call description.

02 Clarifying lighting specifications

Explain lighting units without converting them into an unsupported design recommendation.

03 Agreeing device positions and drawing references

Clarify vertical and horizontal references before accepting a device position.

04 Coordinating containment and shared work areas

Identify the conflict and the people needed to resolve it.

05 Communicating outage plans and status

Give an accurate interruption update without implying equipment is safe to work on.

06 Reporting findings and uncertainty

Explain what a visit did and did not establish.

07 Assessing added equipment and substitutions

Respond to added equipment with a defined information request and conditional quotation.

08 Handing over electrical records

Hand over documents and follow-up responsibilities without implying all checks are complete.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Taking a precise electrical service request

Turn a broad complaint into an accurate service-call description.

CASE

A client reports that the office sockets are dead. Their account concerns two desk receptacles in Room 204, noticed at 08:30. Other areas have not been assessed. A panel directory says office, but its accuracy has not been verified. Clarify the service request without asking the client to test or operate anything.

Teach this move

Ask about existing observations, room labels, and timing. A client report is not a verified circuit finding. Do not direct the client to operate equipment, repeat a fault, open an enclosure, or perform electrical checks.

Vocabulary to check: service call, receptacle, distribution board, circuit identifier.

Model response

When you say the office sockets, do you mean the two desk receptacles in Room 204? I will record that you noticed the issue at 08:30. The directory's office label does not yet confirm which circuit serves them. Please describe what you already observed; the electrician will assess the circuit identification and condition.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The report names its source and limits its extent.

Second-round challenge

A manager calls this a floor-wide outage. Restate the known scope without ruling out unassessed areas.

Language-check answers

1. D - receptacles Correct. Receptacles receive the plugs supplying the desk equipment.
2. C - concerns Correct. 'Concerns' identifies the limited subject of the report.

05 • Conversations

1. Which office sockets? - An electrician clarifies the fictional Room 204 service call by phone.

2. Outlet means different things to different people - An electrician clarifies a shop manager's request about a wall device.

3. Yesterday's account is secondhand - An electrician checks the source of an intermittent complaint with a caretaker.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Two Room 12s

A business has Room 12 in both buildings A and B. A service request names Room 12 and a desk receptacle; the client confirms building B and a west-facing window. No circuit is identified.

Role A: Electrician: clarify the building and room without inventing a circuit assignment.

Role B: Client: confirm building B, Room 12 beside the west-facing window, and reception contact Dana.

Possible opening: Which building contains the Room 12 in your request?

Success checks

- Confirm building B and the room.
- Correct the appointment location verbally.
- Keep circuit identity unverified.

Add a complication: The appointment email still names building A.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Clarifying lighting specifications

Explain lighting units without converting them into an unsupported design recommendation.

CASE

A client selects two fictional luminaires, both listed at 1,200 lumens. One is 3,000 kelvins and the other 4,000 kelvins. The client assumes the larger kelvin number means more light. No product substitution is approved; driver compatibility remains for specialist review.

Teach this move

Lumens describe emitted light; kelvins describe appearance. Neither figure alone establishes suitability, installed brightness, or compatibility. Explain the supplied comparison and leave selection and technical review distinct.

Vocabulary to check: luminaire, color temperature, lumen, driver.

Model response

Both examples are listed at 1,200 lumens, so their stated light output is the same. The kelvin number describes the light's warm or cool appearance, not how much light it emits. The 4,000-kelvin option appears cooler than the 3,000-kelvin option. Product and driver compatibility still need review before either is confirmed.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction separates two different properties.

Second-round challenge

The client asks whether equal lumens guarantee identical lighting on the desk. Explain why the supplied data do not establish that.

Language-check answers

1. C - lumen Correct. Lumens measure the amount of emitted visible light.
2. B - rather than Correct. The contrast corrects the client's confusion.

05 • Conversations

1. Kelvins are not lumens - An electrician compares the client's two proposed luminaires.

2. The fitting code has a suffix - An electrician checks a supplier's proposed lighting delivery.

3. Dimmable does not identify the control - An electrician explains a product-description limit to an interior designer.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Watts on one sheet, lumens on another

One fictional quotation emphasizes 18 watts; another states 1,500 lumens. The client asks which produces more light. Neither provides both figures.

Role A: Electrician: distinguish electrical power from light output and request comparable data.

Role B: Client: you care about useful light and operating cost but have no additional data.

Possible opening: These quotations emphasize different properties, so we cannot compare light output from those two numbers alone.

Success checks

- Name the different units.
- Ask for comparable product information.
- Avoid predicting room performance or costs from incomplete data.

Add a complication: The client suggests choosing the larger number regardless of units.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Agreeing device positions and drawing references

Clarify vertical and horizontal references before accepting a device position.

CASE

A reception elevation shows a device at 1,100 millimeters above finished floor level but does not say whether this is its centerline or lower edge. The joinery drawing uses a centerline. No position has been approved for installation.

Teach this move

A height can refer to the center, edge, or another identified point. State the floor reference and device point separately. Drawings used in an exercise are not placement rules or accessibility standards.

Vocabulary to check: centerline, finished floor level, mounting height, reflected ceiling plan.

Model response

The reception elevation gives 1,100 millimeters above finished floor level, but it does not identify the point on the device being measured. The joinery drawing uses a centerline reference. Could the designer confirm whether the electrical dimension uses the same reference? We need one coordinated location before treating the position as agreed.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision avoids treating matching numbers as matching positions.

Second-round challenge

The client says a matching number proves alignment. Explain the unresolved reference.

Language-check answers

1. B - centerline Correct. The joinery drawing uses the centerline reference given in the case.
2. A - awaiting Correct. 'Awaiting' preserves the unresolved status.

05 • Conversations

1. Eleven hundred to which point? - An electrician and designer resolve the question to be answered for reception.

2. The ceiling plan and the table move - An electrician and project coordinator discuss a revised meeting-room layout.

3. Left as viewed from where? - An electrician clarifies a client's description of a proposed wall control position.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Dimensions in two unit systems

A client's equipment sketch gives a control height in inches. The project elevation uses millimeters and a centerline reference. The sketch does not identify a measurement point.

Role A: Electrician: request explicit units and device reference on a coordinated detail.

Role B: Client: you can obtain the manufacturer's dimensional drawing.

Possible opening: Can we confirm both the units and the point on the control that this dimension refers to?

Success checks

- Distinguish conversion from reference-point clarification.
- Request the dimensional drawing.
- Leave the final position unconfirmed.

Add a complication: The client offers a rounded verbal conversion instead of the drawing.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Coordinating containment and shared work areas

Identify the conflict and the people needed to resolve it.

CASE

Electrical drawing E6 shows a cable tray in ceiling bay C3 where the mechanical layout shows a duct. Neither trade has agreed a revised route. The ceiling coordinator's meeting is at 13:00; the electrician needs both drawings reviewed together.

Teach this move

Describe the overlapping space without declaring which trade must move. A containment-route discussion coordinates design information; it does not teach cable installation, structural penetrations, or service-clearance rules.

Vocabulary to check: conduit, cable tray, containment route, access window.

Model response

Could we review ceiling bay C3 at the 13:00 coordination meeting? Drawing E6 places the cable tray in the same space as the duct on the mechanical layout. Please have both trade leads bring their current drawings. We need a coordinated route decision; I am not proposing an on-site rerouting instruction.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised request identifies a shared coordination problem without allocating blame.

Second-round challenge

The meeting chair offers only ten minutes. State the conflict and required decision concisely.

Language-check answers

1. A - cable tray Correct. E6 identifies a cable tray at the disputed location.
2. D - a coordinated route review Correct. The request seeks joint review before a route decision.

05 · Conversations

1. Two services in bay C3 - An electrician asks the ceiling coordinator for a joint review.
2. Access is shared, not assumed - An electrician and site manager discuss access above a shop counter.
3. A route on paper is not an opening approval - An electrician responds to a builder's interpretation of a containment drawing.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The route label names the wrong floor

A marked containment query is titled Level 3, but drawing E12 and its bay B4 label identify Level 2. No route change is approved. The electrical and mechanical leads for Level 2 need the corrected meeting invitation.

Role A: Electrician: correct the location and ask the coordinator to repeat it back.

Role B: Coordinator: you have already invited the Level 3 supervisor but can correct the invitation.

Possible opening: The query title has the wrong floor; the conflict is in Level 2, bay B4.

Success checks

- Correct the floor and bay explicitly.
- Identify the earlier copy as superseded.
- Confirm the right trade representatives receive the correction.

Add a complication: A participant has printed the earlier query.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Communicating outage plans and status

Give an accurate interruption update without implying equipment is safe to work on.

CASE

An outage request proposes 18:00-19:00 for reception lighting only. Facilities has not approved it. A draft tenant notice incorrectly says the whole floor will be unavailable. No isolation status is supplied and no operational instruction is requested.

Teach this move

An agreed booking, issued notice, or client approval does not establish isolation. Refer technical status to the responsible qualified person. This lesson practices status reporting, not switching, isolation verification, or restoration.

Vocabulary to check: outage window, shutdown notice, isolation status, affected area.

Model response

The request proposes 18:00 to 19:00 for reception lighting only; facilities approval is still pending. The draft notice incorrectly extends that to the whole floor. Please correct the affected area and mark the timing as proposed. This planning update does not establish isolation status or permission to carry out electrical work.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised update makes both boundaries explicit.

Second-round challenge

Facilities approves the requested period. State the planning change without declaring electrical isolation or completion.

Language-check answers

1. D - proposed Correct. The requested window is awaiting approval.
2. C - only Correct. 'Only' limits the stated scope.

05 • Conversations

1. Correcting the tenant notice - An electrician and facilities representative review the draft outage notice.

2. The tenant names an overlooked dependency - An electrician discusses a proposed interruption with an office contact.

3. No restoration time has been confirmed - An electrician relays a status update to a building manager.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The approved notice is for a different date

A reception-lighting notice approved for Tuesday 18:00-19:00 is reused in a draft for Wednesday at the same time. Wednesday's access and outage window are not confirmed. The proposed affected services remain reception lighting only.

Role A: Electrician: distinguish scope continuity from timing approval.

Role B: Facilities coordinator: you can seek Wednesday confirmation but cannot assume it.

Possible opening: The area is unchanged, but Tuesday's approval does not confirm Wednesday's window.

Success checks

- Identify the changed date.
- Keep Wednesday pending.
- Request a correctly dated confirmed notice.

Add a complication: The tenant says the old notice looks official enough.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reporting findings and uncertainty

Explain what a visit did and did not establish.

CASE

A client reported occasional flickering in display bay 2. The electrician's visit note states that flickering was not observed during the visit. No cause is established, and the technical report is pending review. The client asks whether the installation is now fault-free.

Teach this move

Not observed is different from disproved. Identify the observation period and preserve the client's account. Do not interpret measurements, assign pass criteria, or prescribe tests from a language-practice case.

Vocabulary to check: intermittent fault, test report, insulation resistance, provisional diagnosis.

Model response

Flickering was not observed during this visit, but that does not establish that an intermittent fault is absent. Your report about display bay 2 remains part of the service history. The technical report is awaiting review, so I cannot confirm a cause or describe the installation as fault-free from this visit note alone.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction limits the conclusion to the actual observation.

Second-round challenge

The client asks whether a driver replacement is certain to solve it. Preserve the unconfirmed cause and remedy.

Language-check answers

1. C - intermittent Correct. Intermittent means occurring inconsistently.
2. B - is awaiting Correct. Awaiting review means the review is pending.

05 • Conversations

1. Not observed is not ruled out - An electrician explains the display-bay visit note to the client.
2. A result without a matching reference - An electrician queries a report identifier with a test-report coordinator.

3. The symptom returned after the visit - An electrician takes a follow-up account from a shop supervisor.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The report includes an exception

A report summary says review complete but retains an unresolved directory-description mismatch for circuit D4: the directory says store, while the project room plan says archive. The correct identification has not been verified. A manager wants the handover described as no open items.

Role A: Electrician: identify the exception and request its follow-up owner.

Role B: Manager: you can assign report follow-up to the project engineer.

Possible opening: The review is complete, but the D4 observation is still open.

Success checks

- Separate review completion from issue resolution.
- Name D4.
- Confirm who will obtain the next technical response.

Add a complication: The manager argues that complete must mean everything is resolved.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Assessing added equipment and substitutions

Respond to added equipment with a defined information request and conditional quotation.

CASE

A cafe adds a second espresso machine after electrical scope agreement. Its equipment data are unavailable. The client asks to include it at the original price and date. The electrician can request the data and arrange a revised assessment and quotation, but capacity and installation requirements are not established.

Teach this move

Appearance and socket shape do not establish electrical suitability. Ask for manufacturer information and intended use, then separate technical assessment, price, and approval. Do not calculate capacities or prescribe circuit arrangements.

Vocabulary to check: connected load, dedicated circuit, substitution, change quotation.

Model response

The second machine changes the equipment information behind the agreed scope. Could you provide its manufacturer's data and proposed location? We can then assess the additional requirements and prepare a change quotation. I cannot confirm capacity, the original price, or unchanged timing before that review, even if the machine looks similar to the first one.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised response offers a concrete next step without guessing requirements.

Second-round challenge

The supplier offers an alternate model tomorrow. Ask for its complete reference and data without approving the substitution.

Language-check answers

1. B - change quotation Correct. A change quotation addresses a proposed alteration to the agreed work.
2. A - establish Correct. 'Establish' means demonstrate or confirm.

05 · Conversations

1. A second machine changes the enquiry - An electrician discusses an added espresso machine with a cafe owner.
2. The alternate enclosure has different details - An electrician and supplier discuss a proposed product substitution.
3. A dedicated circuit is not spare capacity - An electrician explains terminology in a proposal to a facilities client.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One quotation includes controls

Two fictional lighting-change quotations cover six luminaires. Only quotation A explicitly includes the specified controls; B says fittings only. The client compares totals as equivalent.

Role A: Electrician: explain the scope difference without choosing a product.

Role B: Client: you can request a revised comparable quotation.

Possible opening: Before comparing totals, can we confirm whether both prices include the same controls?

Success checks

- Identify the missing inclusion.
- Request a comparable scope.
- Avoid calling either total better value from incomplete information.

Add a complication: The cheaper supplier says controls can be discussed later.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Handing over electrical records

Hand over documents and follow-up responsibilities without implying all checks are complete.

CASE

At a fictional office handover, the as-built drawings are received. One circuit-directory entry still says old store although the room is now archive. The identification needs verification, not relabeling by assumption. Electrical lead Priya accepts follow-up and will report Thursday. No operational clearance is inferred.

Teach this move

Separate received, reviewed, and reconciled. A room-name change may expose a documentation mismatch without proving the underlying circuit identity. Do not instruct clients to relabel, operate, or investigate electrical equipment.

Vocabulary to check: circuit directory, as-built drawing, commissioning record, outstanding item.

Model response

The as-built drawings have been received, but the directory entry marked old store still needs reconciliation with the archive-room reference. Priya has accepted that follow-up and will report Thursday. Please keep the discrepancy visible in the handover record. Receipt of the drawings does not resolve the directory question or establish any separate operational clearance.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision distinguishes document receipt from verified identification.

Second-round challenge

Priya reports that source-record review is still pending Thursday. Keep the issue open and clarify the next update.

Language-check answers

1. A - a check against the confirmed installation record Correct. Reconciliation with confirmed installation information can establish the identity.
2. D - has accepted Correct. Present perfect describes the confirmed acceptance.

05 · Conversations

1. The archive still says old store - An electrician hands over documents to the facilities client.
2. A record belongs to another asset - An electrician checks a commissioning document with a building representative.
3. Handover does not replace user orientation - An electrician clarifies a client's request for a building-team briefing.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A contact change before closeout

Priya leaves before the directory query is resolved: row 7 says old store, while the current room plan names archive. The circuit relationship is unverified. Omar agrees to take document follow-up, with a status call Friday; technical findings remain pending.

Role A: Outgoing electrician: give the entry reference and confirm Omar's acceptance.

Role B: Omar: repeat the query and distinguish the Friday update from completion.

Possible opening: Can you accept follow-up on the unresolved archive-room directory entry?

Success checks

- Transfer the exact query.
- Confirm Omar's acceptance.
- Preserve the pending technical status.

Add a complication: The client thinks a new owner means a new technical finding.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional occupational English practice, not electrical training or advice on design, testing, isolation, switching, energizing, repairs, or installation. All case facts, ratings, dimensions, schedules, and incidents are invented. Do not operate or investigate equipment to enact a scenario. Technical decisions and safety status belong to qualified personnel using applicable site arrangements; no universal code, permit, or licensing rules are asserted. Occupational sources inform context, not the invented technical cases.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Electricians

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/construction-and-extraction/electricians.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Electricians (47-2111.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/47-2111.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.